AccessProof

CUSTOMER ONBOARDING GUIDE

From sign-up to a protected AI assistant

A step-by-step guide for connecting SharePoint and your RAG application, and turning on verified protection.

WHO IT'S FOR

Owners, Microsoft admins, IT engineers and RAG application owners

WHAT YOU'LL DO

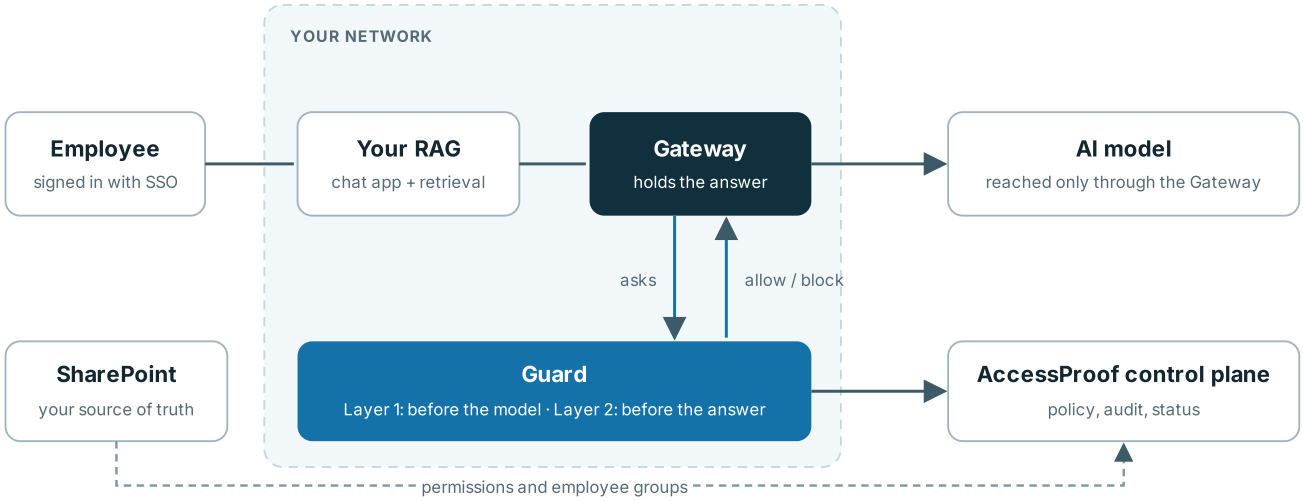
Eight phases, from workspace to go-live

VERSION

November 2026

How onboarding works

AccessProof makes sure your AI assistant only answers from documents the person asking is allowed to see, using the permissions already set in SharePoint. If access is removed, or AccessProof can't confirm it, the answer is blocked.



Every question is checked twice: Layer 1 before documents reach the model, Layer 2 before the answer is released.

Your eight phases

1. **Create workspace** — Owner
2. **Connect SharePoint** — Microsoft admin
3. **Install Guard** — IT / platform
4. **Register AI app** — Owner
5. **Connect your RAG** — RAG app owner
6. **Verify with AccessProof** — Everyone + AccessProof
7. **Approve and enable** — Owner
8. **Test and operate** — RAG app owner

Three things to know before you begin

- **Nothing changes for employees during setup.** Installing the Gateway does not reroute your chatbot. Traffic moves only at the cutover in Phase 6, which you authorize.
- **Connected is not the same as protected.** The dashboard says "Protected" only after every security check passes and the Guard confirms it. Pairing or a heartbeat alone never counts.
- **Some steps are done together.** Phases 1 to 5 are yours. Phases 6 and 7 are run jointly with your AccessProof engineer, because they use independent, signed checks.

Before you start

Get these people and items lined up first. Most delays come from waiting on an administrator part-way through.

Who you need

ROLE	WHAT THEY DO	PHASES
Workspace Owner	Creates the workspace and gives final approval to turn on protection	1, 4, 7
Microsoft administrator	Approves consent in Entra and grants AccessProof access to one SharePoint site	2
IT / platform engineer	Installs the Guard and Gateway on a Linux host with Docker	3, 5
RAG application owner	Knows the chatbot code, connects it, and runs the tests	5, 6, 8
Two test employees	One allowed and one denied, used for allow and deny tests	6, 8

Checklist

Microsoft 365

- [ ] A Microsoft 365 tenant, and its Entra tenant ID
- [ ] One SharePoint site and document library for the assistant
- [ ] A folder inside it that sets the approved boundary
- [ ] Two dedicated test accounts, not real people's accounts
- [ ] Test documents only: one the allowed user can open and the denied user can't

Your host

- [ ] Linux host with Docker Engine and Docker Compose
- [ ] Python 3 on the Docker host, for the Gateway installer
- [ ] Outbound HTTPS to `api.accessproof.in`
- [ ] No inbound ports open to the internet are needed

Your RAG application must

- [ ] Sign employees in with Microsoft Entra SSO
- [ ] Keep the source and document IDs on each retrieved chunk
- [ ] Have no other route that returns document text
- [ ] Pass each employee's own token on every request
- [ ] Reach the AI model only through the Gateway
- [ ] Wait for approval before showing an answer (no live streaming past the Gateway)

> **Platform support**
> Linux is the validated platform. The Guard download includes Windows and macOS launchers, but a Windows RAG host can't be certified yet. Talk to your AccessProof engineer first if you plan to use one.

1 Create your workspace

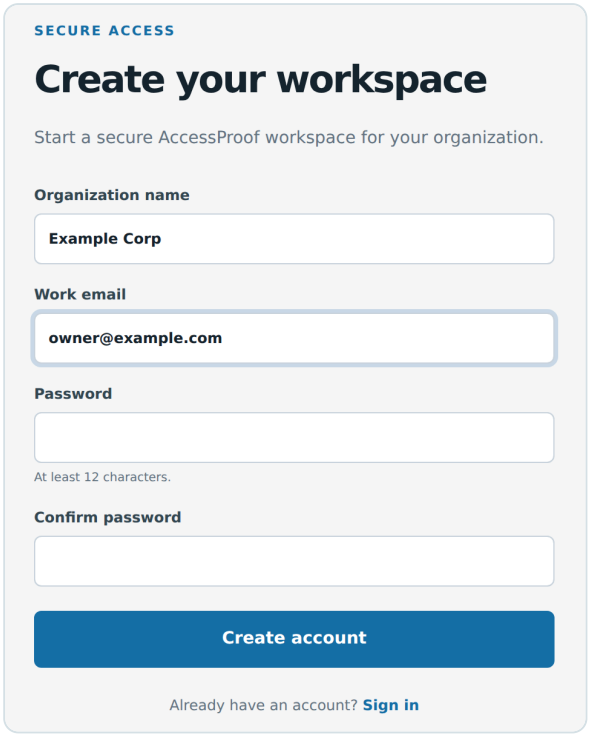
Workspace Owner

This account becomes the Owner, the only role that can give final approval in Phase 7.

1. Go to `app.accessproof.in/register`.
2. Enter your organization name, work email and a password of at least 12 characters, then choose **Create account**.
3. Open the verification email and confirm your address.
4. Sign in. Go to **Settings** and choose **Set up two-factor** to protect the Owner account.
5. In the sidebar, select **Get Started**. This page tracks your progress from here on.

Invite your team

Add the people from your role list in Settings so that each person uses their own account. Don't share the Owner login.



The sign-up form

Your home base: Get Started

Get Started tracks your setup in 3 steps. Step 1 covers Phase 2, step 2 covers Phases 3 to 5, and step 3 covers Phases 6 to 8.



Setup progress on the Get Started page. Screens in this guide use sample data.

You are done with this phase when

- You can sign in and your email is verified
- Two-factor authentication is on for the Owner
- You can see Get Started in the sidebar

2 Connect SharePoint

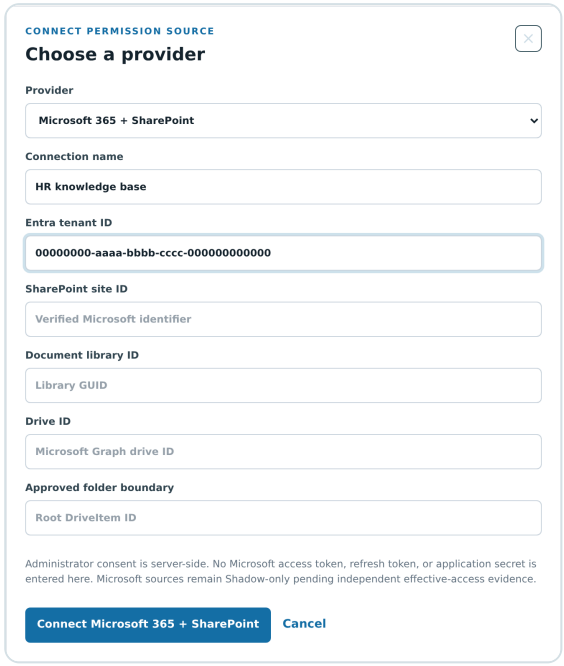
Microsoft administrator

You tell AccessProof which folder is approved, then a Microsoft admin authorizes access.

Collect the IDs

The form needs Microsoft identifiers, so gather them first. There is no site picker yet. Your admin can read them in Microsoft Graph Explorer.

FORM FIELD	WHERE TO FIND IT
Entra tenant ID	Entra admin center, Overview
SharePoint site ID	`GET /sites/{host}:/sites/{name}` → `id`
Document library ID	`GET /sites/{site-id}/lists` → `id`
Drive ID	`GET /sites/{site-id}/drives` → `id`
Approved folder boundary	`GET /drives/{drive-id}/root:/{folder}` → `id`



The SharePoint connection form

Fill in the form

1. Open **Permission sources** and choose **Connect source**.
2. Set **Provider** to **Microsoft 365 + SharePoint**.
3. Give it a clear name and paste the IDs.
4. Select **Connect Microsoft 365 + SharePoint**. No tokens or secrets are entered here.

> **Use a dedicated site**
> Keep the approved boundary small and specific. The site should hold only what this assistant may use, and start with test documents.

Approve access: two separate grants

Microsoft access takes two grants. Consent alone gives AccessProof access to **zero** sites, so the first attempt can return *consent failed*. That is expected if the site grant isn't in place yet.

1. **Admin consent.** You are sent to Microsoft. An administrator of your tenant approves the AccessProof application. The link expires after 10 minutes. It requests `Sites.Selected`, `User.Read.All` and `Group.Read.All`.
2. **Site grant.** Your SharePoint administrator gives the AccessProof application access to the one approved site:

```
POST https://graph.microsoft.com/v1.0/sites/{site-id}/permissions
{
  "roles": ["fullcontrol"],
  "grantedToIdentities": [{ "application": {
    "id": "b8424d54-5428-4d35-ae2c-639de7e512a9",
    "displayName": "AccessProof" } }]
}
```

3. **Reauthorize.** Back in Permission sources, select **Authorize / reauthorize** on your source. AccessProof now confirms it can reach the approved folder.
4. **Sync.** Select **Sync employees & groups**, then **Sync permissions**.

> **Why fullcontrol?**
> It applies only to the site you name. AccessProof needs it to read each person's effective permissions, a right that Microsoft includes only in this role. This is why a dedicated site matters.

SOURCE	PROVIDER	CONNECTION STATE	PERMISSION FRESHNESS
HR knowledge base Approved folder: AI-Assistant-Docs	Microsoft 365 + SharePoint	Shadow Shadow only: independent Microsoft effective-access certification is required for Protect.	Employees/groups: Fresh Permissions: Fresh

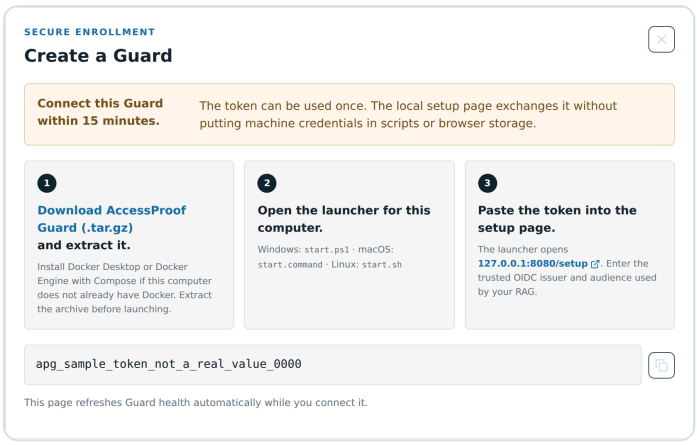
A healthy source. "Shadow" is normal here: it stays until certification in Phase 6.

> **You are done with this phase when**
> - The source shows no connection error
> - **Employees/groups** and **Permissions** both show **Fresh**
> - Your test employees appear under **Employees** and **Identity resolution**
> - Step 01 on Get Started shows **Connected**

3 Install the Guard

IT / platform engineer

The Guard is the enforcement point. It runs on your network and decides every request.



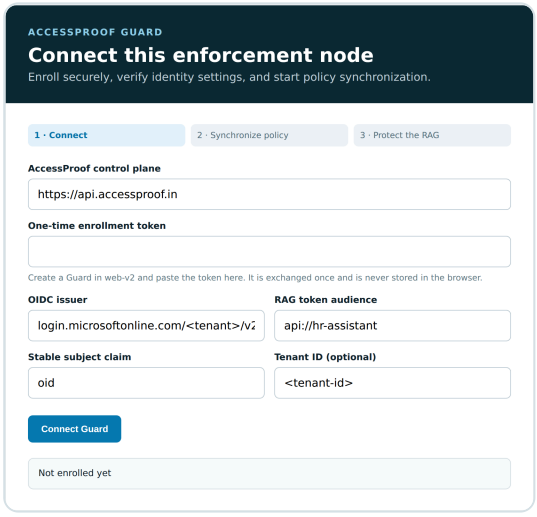
After you create a Guard, the dashboard shows your token and these steps

1. Open **Guards** and choose **Create Guard**.
2. Enter a name, such as `hr-rag-guard`, and an environment. Select **Create and generate token**.
3. Copy the token. **It works once and expires in 15 minutes.**
4. Download the Guard package and extract it on your Linux host. It needs Docker with Compose.

```
./start.sh     # opens the local setup page at http://127.0.0.1:8080/setup
```

5. On the setup page, keep the control plane address and paste your token.
6. Enter your identity settings, using the values below.
7. Select **Connect Guard**. The status changes to connected and policy sync begins.

FIELD	VALUE FOR MICROSOFT ENTRA
OIDC issuer	`https://login.microsoftonline.com/<tenant-id>/v2.0`
RAG token audience	The audience in your RAG's tokens, such as `api://hr-assistant`
Stable subject claim	`oid` (change from the default `sub`)
Tenant ID	Your Entra tenant ID



The local Guard setup page. "web-v2" in the hint means your AccessProof dashboard.

You are done with this phase when

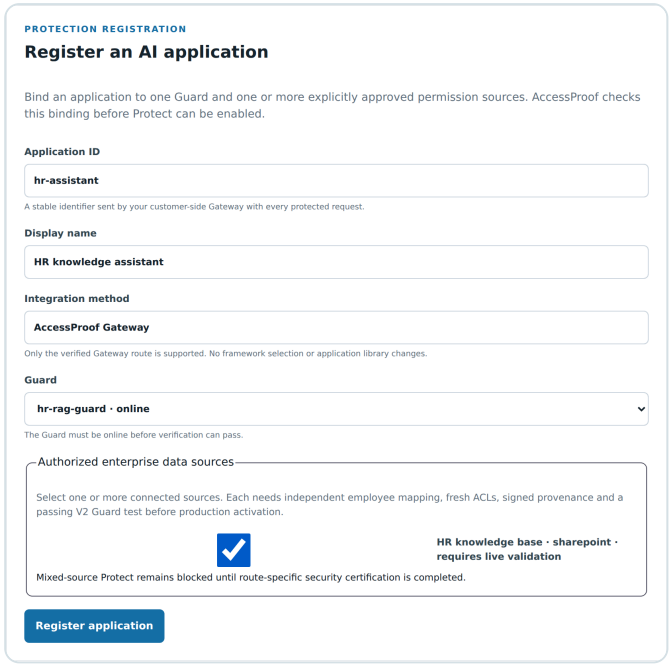
- The Guard shows **online** under Guards, with a policy version
- A recent **Last heartbeat** time is showing

4 Register your AI application

Workspace Owner

This tells AccessProof which chatbot uses which Guard and which approved source.

1. Open **AI applications** and choose **Register application**.
2. **Application ID:** a short, permanent name such as `hr-assistant`. It is sent with every protected request, so don't change it later.
3. **Display name:** the name your team will recognize.
4. **Guard:** select the Guard from Phase 3.
5. **Sources:** tick the SharePoint source from Phase 2.
6. Select **Register application**.



Registering an application

One source for your first application

Applications that mix several sources stay blocked from Protect until that mixed route has its own certification. One source is the simplest start.

You are done with this phase when

- The application is listed under AI applications
- Its row shows your Guard and source
- Protection is not active yet. That is expected at this stage.

5 Connect your RAG

RAG application owner

The Gateway sits between your RAG and the AI model. Pick the path that matches how your RAG runs.

Path A

RAG runs in Docker Compose

Paired from the dashboard with a one-time file. The RAG must already support signed retrieval, identity forwarding and buffered answers.

Path B

LangChain, LlamaIndex or Python RAG on another server

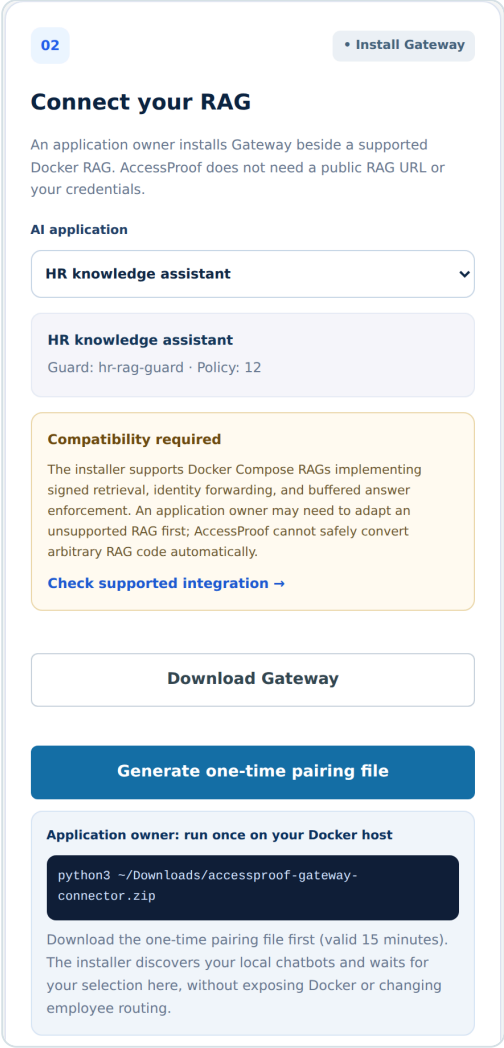
You add a small client library and keep your retriever and vector database. Set up with your AccessProof engineer.

Path A: step by step

1. On **Get Started**, in step 02, pick your application and select **Download Gateway**.
2. Select **Generate one-time pairing file**. **It is valid for 15 minutes,** so do the next step right away.
3. On your Docker host, run the installer once from your Compose project:

```
python3 ~/Downloads/accessproof-gateway-
connector.zip
```

4. Return to Get Started. Under **Choose one chatbot to connect**, your local chatbots are listed. Select the one marked **Compatible candidate**, then **Confirm this one chatbot**. Entries marked **Adapter required** need code changes first.
5. The installer rechecks your choice, then starts the Gateway only. Your other containers and employee routing stay as they are.



Step 02 on Get Started

Already have a Gateway?

Don't install a second one. An installed Gateway is recognized, and running the installer again only re-reports it.

Path B: step by step

1. Your AccessProof engineer helps you set up a TLS Gateway, and gives you its URL, a client ID and secret, and a CA bundle.
2. Install the client: `pip install "accessproof-rag[langchain]"`, or `[llamaindex]`.
3. Index your documents through **AccessProof trusted ingestion**. Chunks without valid provenance are refused, and attestations must stay refreshed.
4. Replace your model call with the AccessProof client. Store the secret in a secret manager, never in code.

Both paths: close the side doors

The route check looks at the whole RAG host, not only the chat route. In testing, a host with a working protected route still failed because of these two problems:

FIX THIS	WHY IT MATTERS
Remove direct model access. Delete model API keys from the RAG host, and block its path to any model endpoint.	Otherwise code could call the model and skip every permission check.
Close alternate routes. Remove or protect search, debug and other endpoints that return document text.	An unprotected route can leak what the main route blocks.

Check the connection

1. Open **AI applications** and choose **Check & Enable Protection**.
2. Select **Check Guard & Gateway** and read the Gateway tiles.
3. Close the panel. Protection stays off for now; that comes in Phase 7.

You are done with this phase when

- Path A: step 02 on Get Started shows **Installed**
- Both paths: Gateway live connection reads **Connected · ready**

6 Verify with AccessProof

Everyone + AccessProof engineer

Independent checks prove the protection works on your real route. A working chat answer isn't proof.

Book a session with your AccessProof engineer. Your engineer runs the checks and you provide access for them. Nothing here is a self-service button.

What you do

- [ ] Have both test employees sign in when asked. Their tokens are held in memory only.
- [ ] Allow a live permission change on a test document, which is restored afterwards.
- [ ] Allow short, planned Guard and Gateway outages to prove requests fail closed.
- [ ] Give your engineer agreed, temporary access to run checks on the RAG host.
- [ ] Have your Owner authorize moving the employee route, known as the cutover.

What gets checked

STAGE	WHAT IT PROVES	RESULT YOU SHOULD SEE
Source certificate	Your SharePoint permissions, identities and revocation behave correctly on your own Guard and route	Signed certificate, valid for 30 days
Route certification	14 checks on your route, listed below	CERTIFIED, 14 of 14
Route challenge	Live allow, deny, tamper and revocation requests, matched to Guard audit records	Allow, deny and blocks all as expected
Cutover	Employee traffic now goes through the Gateway	Cutover verified

The 14 route checks

- ✓ Allowed access is released
- ✓ Revoked document is denied
- ✓ Provenance is verified
- ✓ Tampered or replayed requests are rejected
- ✓ Tenants stay isolated
- ✓ No unprotected alternate routes
- ✓ Fails closed if Guard is down
- ✓ Unauthorized access is denied
- ✓ Mid-request revocation is blocked
- ✓ Forged content is rejected
- ✓ Cached answers can't be replayed
- ✓ No direct model bypass
- ✓ Fails closed if Gateway is down
- ✓ Gateway and Guard audits match

If a check fails

That is the process working. Fix the cause, then re-run it. Don't add exceptions or force-allow a request to get a pass.

You are done with this phase when

- Source certificate and route certificate are both valid
- Cutover is verified
- Your engineer confirms that only owner approval remains

7 Approve and enable protection

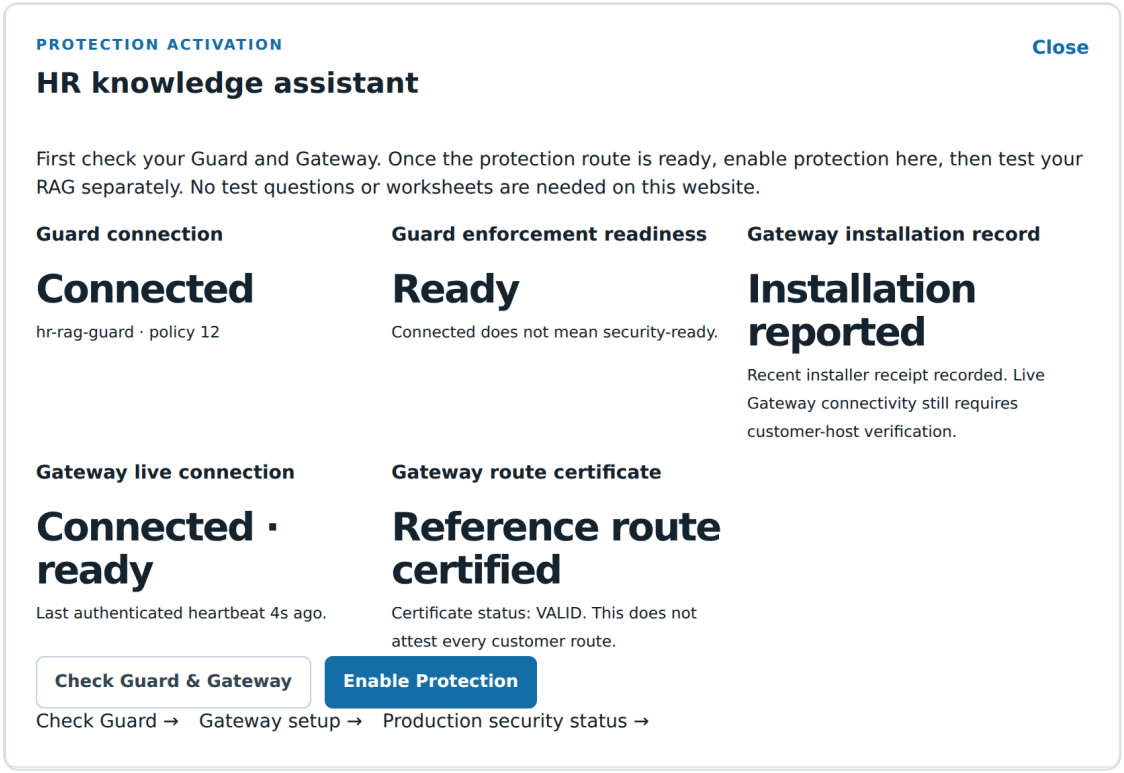
Workspace Owner

This is a deliberate human decision. No automated process can turn protection on.

1. **Give owner approval.** With your AccessProof engineer, the Owner approves in their own signed-in session, giving a reviewer name and typing this text exactly:

```
APPROVE PROTECT <your-application-id>
```

2. Open **AI applications** and choose **Check & Enable Protection** on your application.
3. Select **Check Guard & Gateway** and read each tile. Guard connection, Guard readiness and Gateway live connection should look like the example.
4. Select **Enable Protection**.
5. Wait for the message **Protection active — now test your RAG**. This appears only after the Guard acknowledges it.



The check panel with everything ready. Enable Protection stays disabled until the Guard is ready and the Gateway is paired.

> **Approval is tied to the current route**
>
> If your route is re-tested or re-certified after approval, a new approval is needed.

> **You are done with this phase when**
>
> - The result reads **Protection active**
> - Your application shows **Protected Verified**
> - Get Started shows 3 of 3

8 Test your RAG, then keep it healthy

RAG application owner

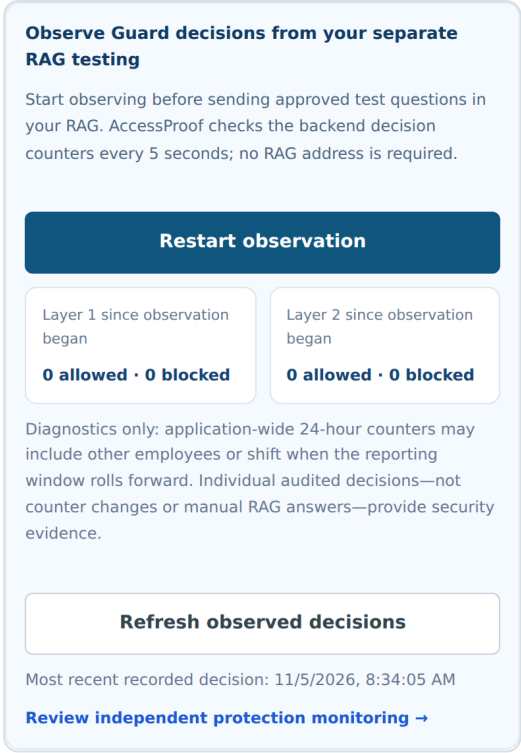
Test in your own chatbot, not in AccessProof. No separate URL is needed.

Run your test

1. On **Get Started**, select **Start observing test requests**.
2. Open your chatbot and sign in as the **allowed** test employee with your usual Microsoft SSO. Ask about the test document.
3. Sign out, sign in as the **denied** test employee and ask the same question.
4. Compare with the table below, then review **Blocked requests** and **Audit**.

WHO ASKS	EXPECTED RESULT
Allowed employee	Gets an answer from the test document. Layer 1 and 2 count as allowed.
Denied employee	Gets no content from the document. The block appears in Blocked requests.

> **Never paste tokens or passwords**
> AccessProof doesn't need them. Use test documents, not sensitive ones.



The counters are for live feedback. They can include other traffic, so audit records are the real evidence.

Keeping protection healthy

WHAT	HOW OFTEN	WHAT YOU DO
Source certificate	Valid 30 days; renewed when 10 days or fewer remain	Have test employees sign in when asked
Route certificate	Valid 7 days; re-certified when 2 days or fewer remain	Have test employees sign in when asked
Route attestation	Automatic, twice a day	Nothing, unless a route goes stale
RAG configuration changes	Whenever you change the code, config or Gateway	Tell AccessProof first: a change invalidates the route certificate

Check **Protection**, **Blocked requests** and **Audit** regularly. If a certificate lapses, requests fail closed: they are blocked, never allowed through.

If something goes wrong

AccessProof fails closed. When it isn't sure, it blocks. A blocked request usually means something needs fixing, not bypassing.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
Consent failed after Microsoft approval	The site grant isn't in place, or an ID is wrong	Complete the site grant, check the IDs, then select **Authorize / reauthorize**
Microsoft consent not configured message	Setup is needed on the AccessProof side	Contact AccessProof. Don't paste a Microsoft token
Sources show **Not synced** or stale	Directory or permission sync hasn't finished	Select the two sync actions and check the error on the source
Source shows **Shadow**	Normal before certification	No action. Continue to Phase 6
Guard token rejected	Used already, or past 15 minutes	Create a new token
Guard **connected** but **degraded**	Online, but source or identity evidence is incomplete	Check source freshness. Legitimate requests may be blocked until it clears
Pairing file expired	Past the 15 minutes	Generate a new file and run the installer again
Chatbot shows **Adapter required**	RAG lacks signed retrieval, identity forwarding or buffering	Use the integration help, or ask about Path B
No chatbots listed	The installer isn't running, or pairing expired	Run the installer on the Docker host, then select **Refresh discovered chatbots**
Gateway reads **Unknown** or **Disconnected**	No recent authenticated heartbeat	Check the Gateway container. Don't install a second Gateway. Re-run the installer to re-report the existing one
Enable Protection is greyed out	The Guard isn't ready, or the Gateway isn't paired	Follow the message under the panel
Protection not active yet	A check, the certificate or owner approval is missing	Read the **Current blocker** line and go to **Production security status**
Allowed employee is blocked	Identity mapping, freshness or Guard readiness	Check **Identity resolution** and **Blocked requests**. Never force-allow
AUTHORIZATION_REVISION_CHANGED	Permissions changed during the request	Retry. If it persists, contact AccessProof
SOURCE_CONTENT_ATTESTATION_FAILED	Content is altered, or its attestation expired	Check that trusted ingestion refresh is running
ATTESTATION_STALE	Route couldn't be verified for 24 hours	Restore the connection to the RAG host, and contact AccessProof

Need help?

Email **admin@accessproof.in** with your application ID, the exact message and the time it happened. Never include tokens, secrets or passwords.

Your go-live checklist

Print this page or share it with your team. Each line needs a name and date before you call onboarding complete.

✓	ITEM	OWNER	DATE
☐	Workspace created, and two-factor is on for the Owner		
☐	SharePoint admin consent approved		
☐	Site grant limited to the one approved site		
☐	Employees/groups and Permissions both show Fresh		
☐	Test employees appear in Identity resolution		
☐	Guard online, with a policy version		
☐	AI application registered with one Guard and one source		
☐	Gateway connected and ready		
☐	Model keys and direct model access removed from the RAG host		
☐	Source certificate valid		
☐	Route CERTIFIED, 14 of 14		
☐	Employee route cutover verified		
☐	Owner approval given		
☐	Protection active and acknowledged by the Guard		
☐	Allowed employee gets an answer		
☐	Denied employee gets no document content		
☐	Blocked request visible in Blocked requests and Audit		
☐	Team knows to tell AccessProof before changing the RAG		

Words you'll see

Guard: software on your network that makes each allow or block decision.

Shadow: observing only, not enforcing.

Fail closed: if a check can't complete, the request is blocked.

Gateway: sits between your RAG and the model, and holds answers until approved.

Protect: enforcing, so unauthorized requests are blocked.

Cutover: the approved move of employee traffic onto the protected route.